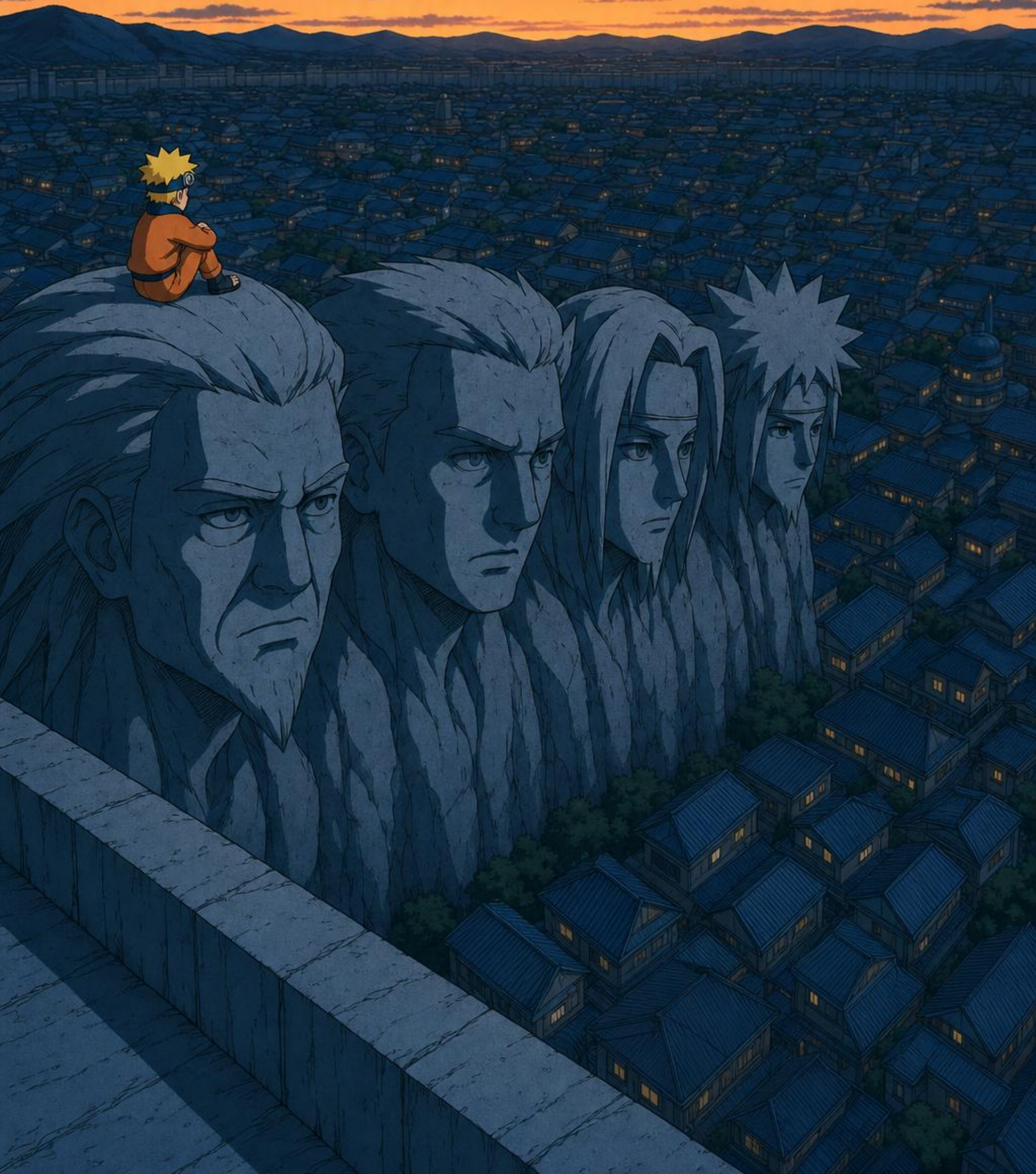


CHAPTER FOUR

KUSHINA

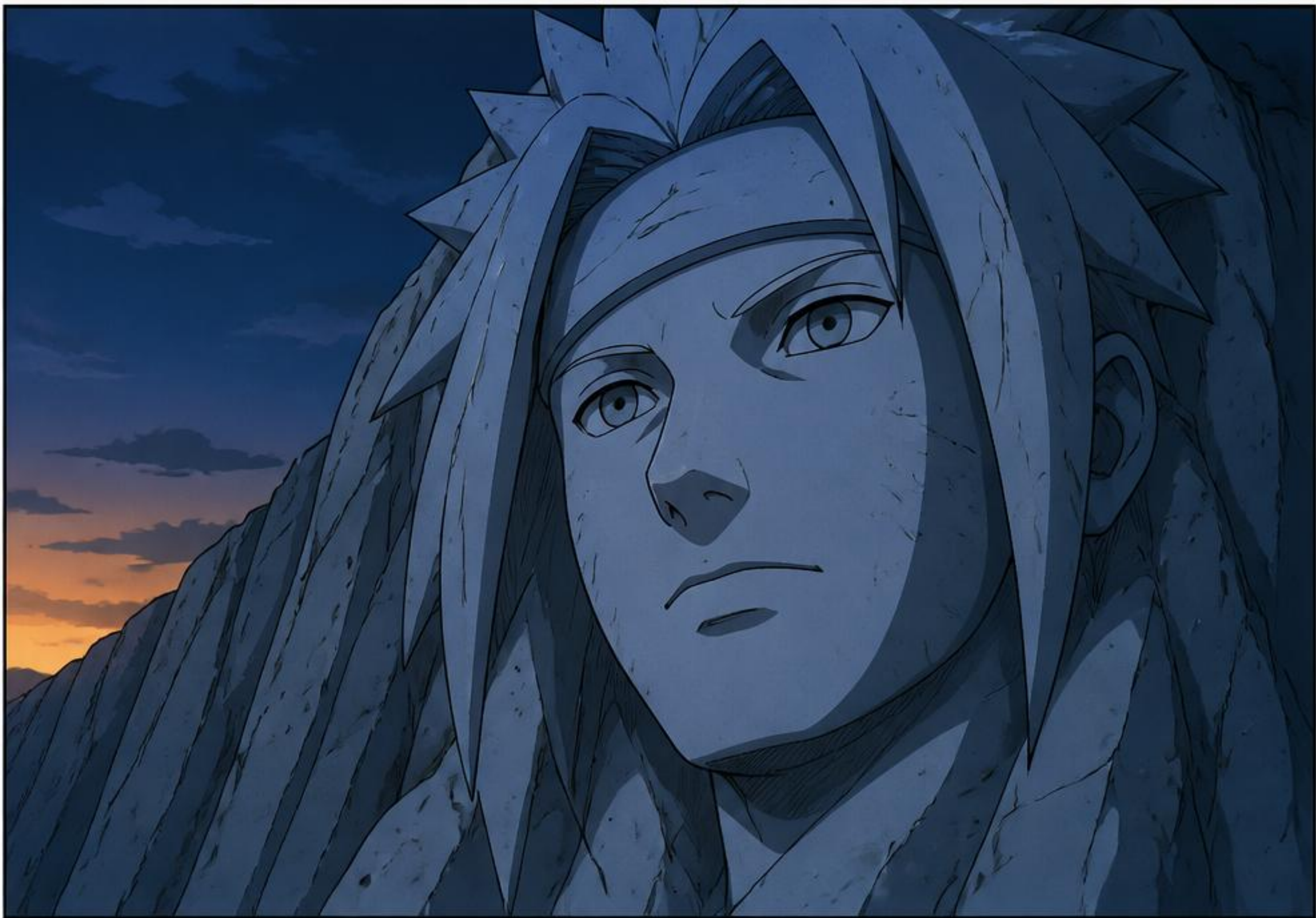
UCHIHA NARUTO: THE SAGE . VOLUME ONE

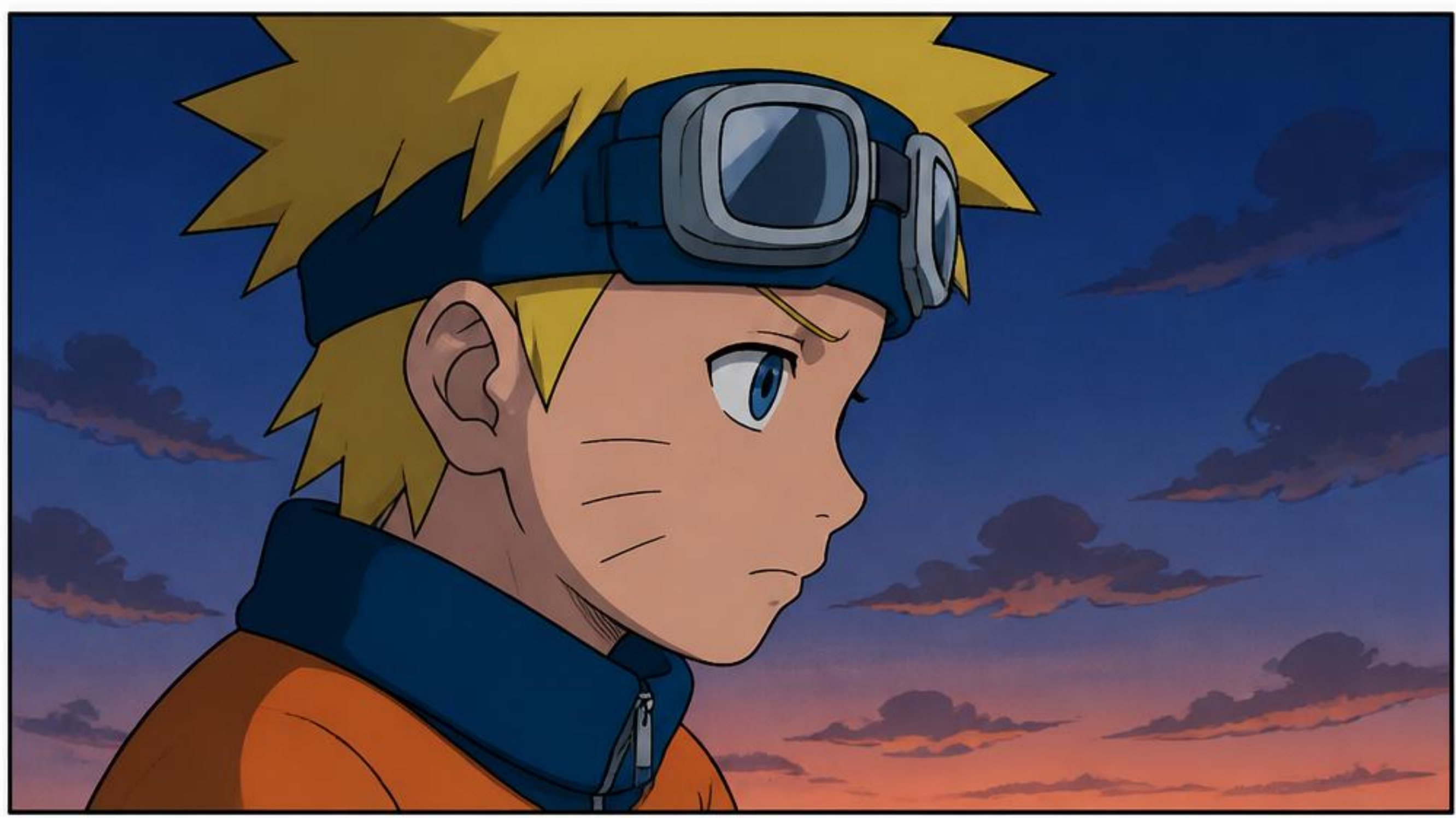














A young woman with brown hair tied in a ponytail, wearing a white headscarf and a white apron over a white shirt, stands in a kitchen. She is holding a stack of five light-colored bowls. The kitchen has wooden shelves with more bowls and a glowing orange paper lantern hanging from the ceiling. The scene is set at night, with a dark street visible through the open doorway.

Naruto! I
haven't seen
you in three
months -
where have
you been?

The young woman is kneeling on the floor, hugging a young boy with spiky blonde hair and blue eyes. The boy is wearing an orange jumpsuit and a blue headband with goggles. The woman is wearing the same white headscarf and apron as in the first panel. The kitchen setting is the same, with the glowing lantern and wooden shelves visible in the background.

Don't you
ever do that
to me again.
I was
worried sick.



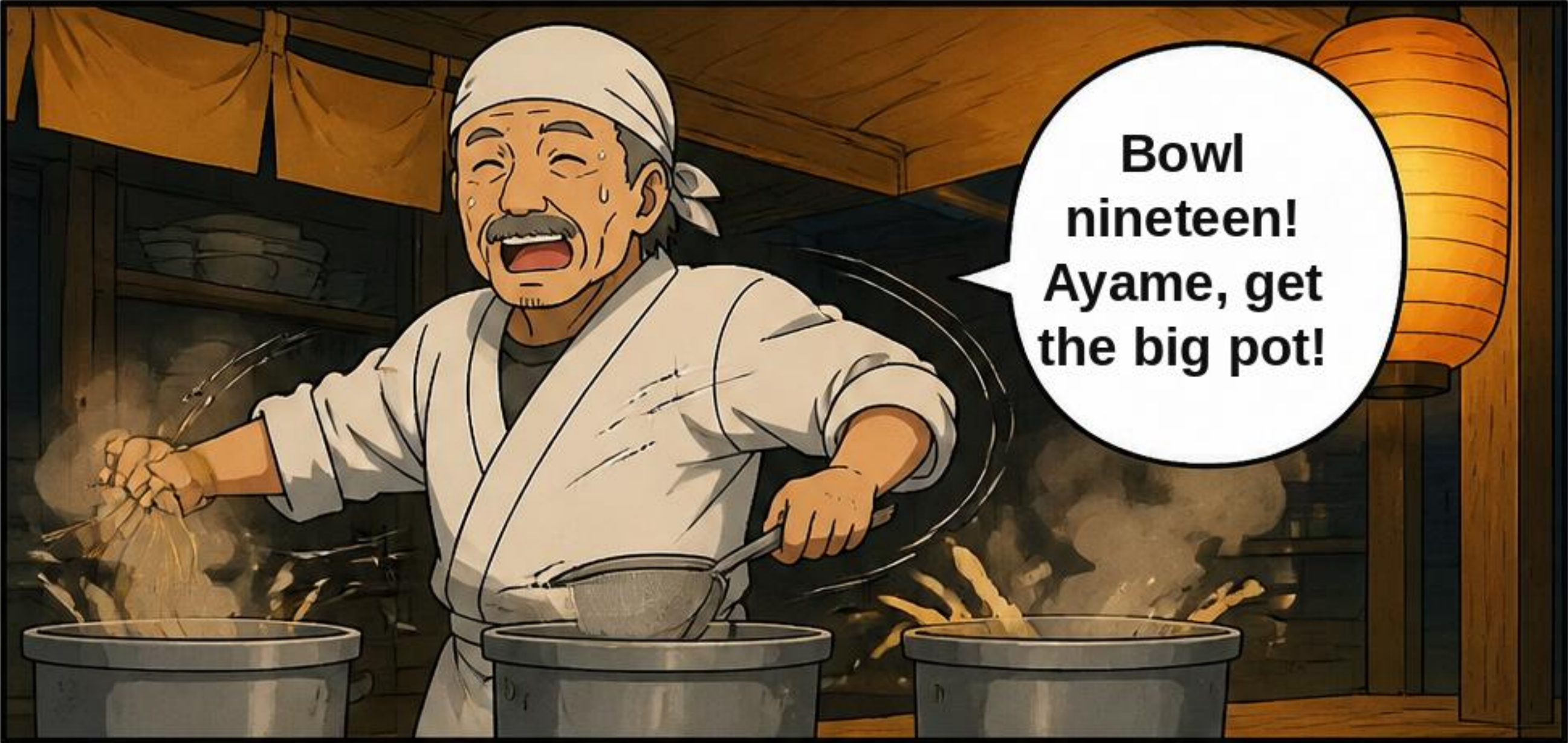
Three whole months! Then the first six bowls are on the house, kid.



Then make it twenty-six bowls of miso pork. And keep 'em coming!



...Twenty-six.



A young woman with dark hair tied in a ponytail, wearing a white headscarf and a white chef's coat, is leaning over a wooden counter. She is using a white cloth to wipe the face of a young boy with spiky blonde hair and a blue headband with goggles. The boy is sitting at the counter, looking slightly annoyed. In front of him is a large white bowl of ramen with chopsticks and a small brown cup. The background shows a kitchen with shelves of bowls and a warm, yellow light from a lantern.

Hold still.
You've got
broth all over
your face.

An older man with a white headscarf and a white chef's coat is sitting at a wooden counter, smiling broadly. He has a mustache and is looking towards a young woman who is standing with her back to him. She is wearing a white headscarf and a white chef's coat. The background shows a kitchen with shelves of bowls and steam rising from a pot.

Ha! Let the
boy eat like a
boy, Ayame.

A close-up of the young boy with spiky blonde hair and a blue headband with goggles. He is looking directly forward with a slight smile. The background is dark and blurry, showing the interior of the ramen shop.

You come back
whenever
you're hungry,
kid. Any night.
You hear me?







In one of the
history books
I gave you
there was a
man called
Uchiha
Madara.



The one who
fought the
Shodaime
Hokage. The
one who lost.



I am
that
man.



...Huh.



That
can't
be
true.



Madara died
fighting the
Shodaime.
It's in the
book you
gave me, old
man.



Hm.
Perhaps
you are
right.



Since you won't
believe that -
how about I tell
you about your
parents instead.





...Okay.

And listen carefully. I will say this only once.



Your mother was the jinchuuriki of the Kyuubi. Before it was sealed inside you.







Her name
was
Kushina
Uzumaki.



...Kushina.